HD-024

High

Requested By

IT Administrator

Domain

aklab.local

Service Request:

IT Communication

The IT department requires a centralised announcement system to notify domain users whenever new IT policies, security changes, or service improvements are implemented.

Following the implementation of automated file version history, employees must be informed about the new functionality and how to access previous versions of shared documents.

Environment: DC01 (domain controller) and CLIENT01 (Windows client)

1. Requested Action

1. Create a centralized location for storing approved IT announcements.
2. Configure appropriate permissions to prevent unauthorized users from modifying announcements.
3. Implement a PowerShell-based notification mechanism.
4. Deploy the notification mechanism to domain users through Group Policy.
5. Configure notifications to appear when users sign in.
6. Prevent duplicate notifications for announcements already displayed.
7. Test the announcement system using Jamie Taylor and John Reed on CLIENT01.

Note: Only the Administrator should be allowed to publish an announcement.

2. Environment

- User account: AKLAB\Administrator
- Shared resource: \\DC01\CompanyShare
- for the folders in the address bar: the message pops up

3. Resolution

Let's create a folder for Annoucements:

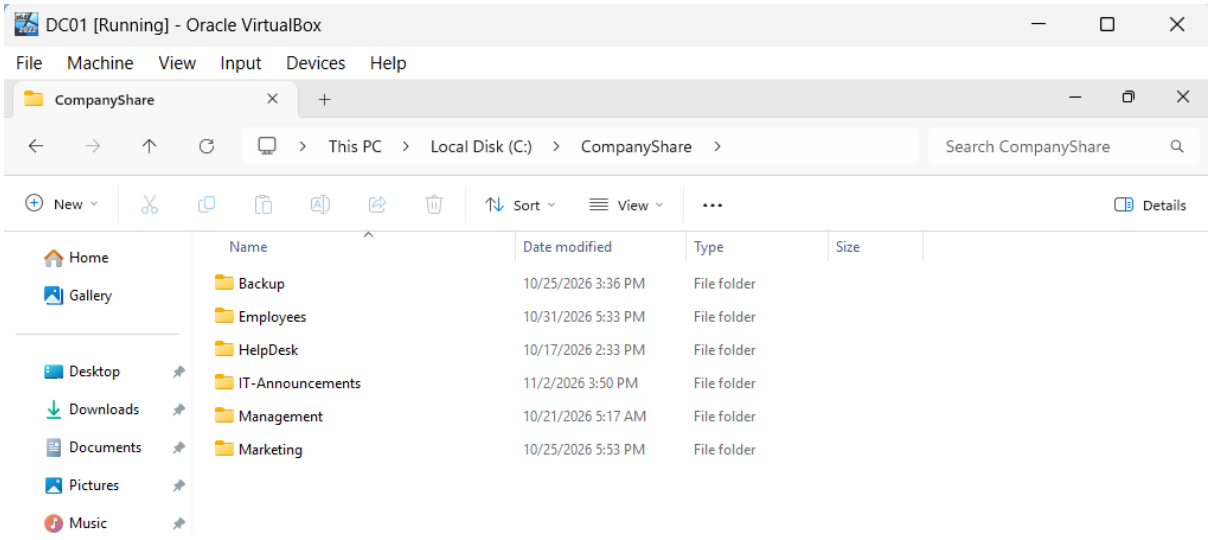


Figure 1: IT-Announcements folder is created

Let's configure the permissions now:

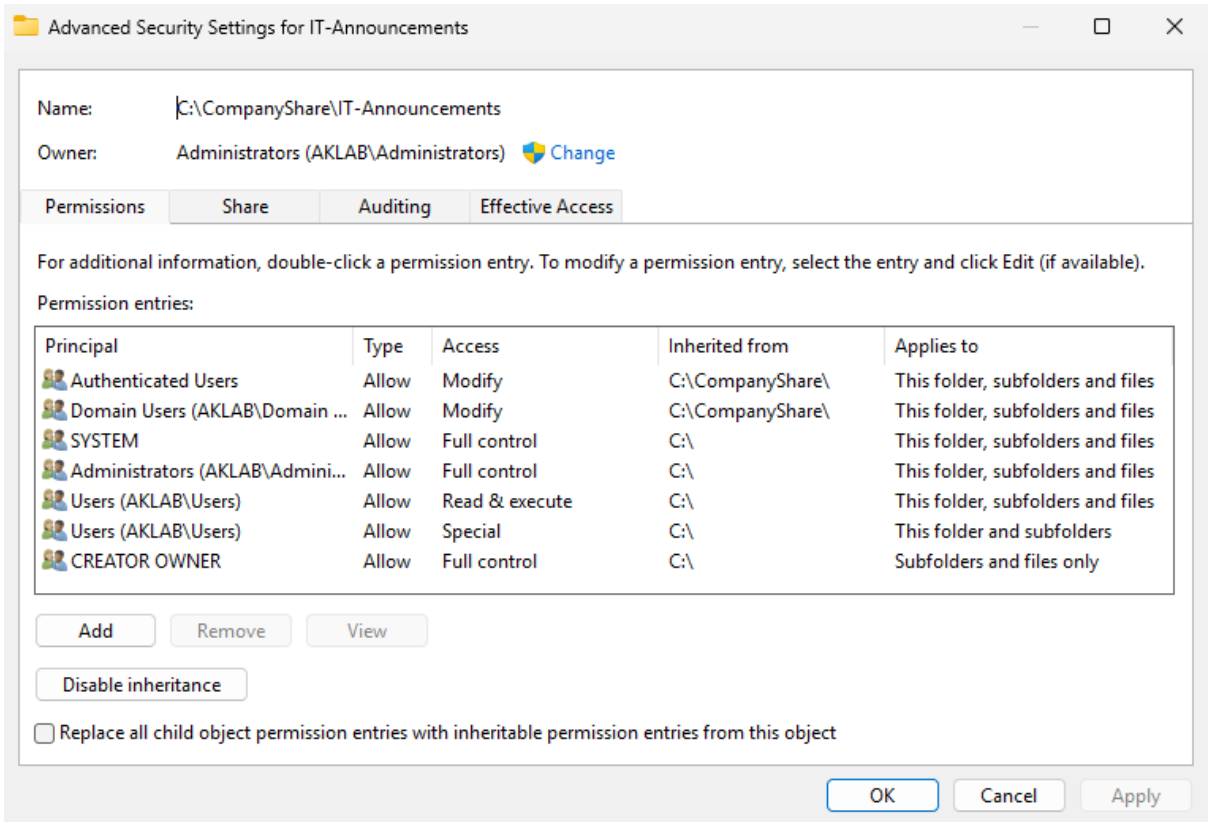


Figure 2: Permissions before configuring

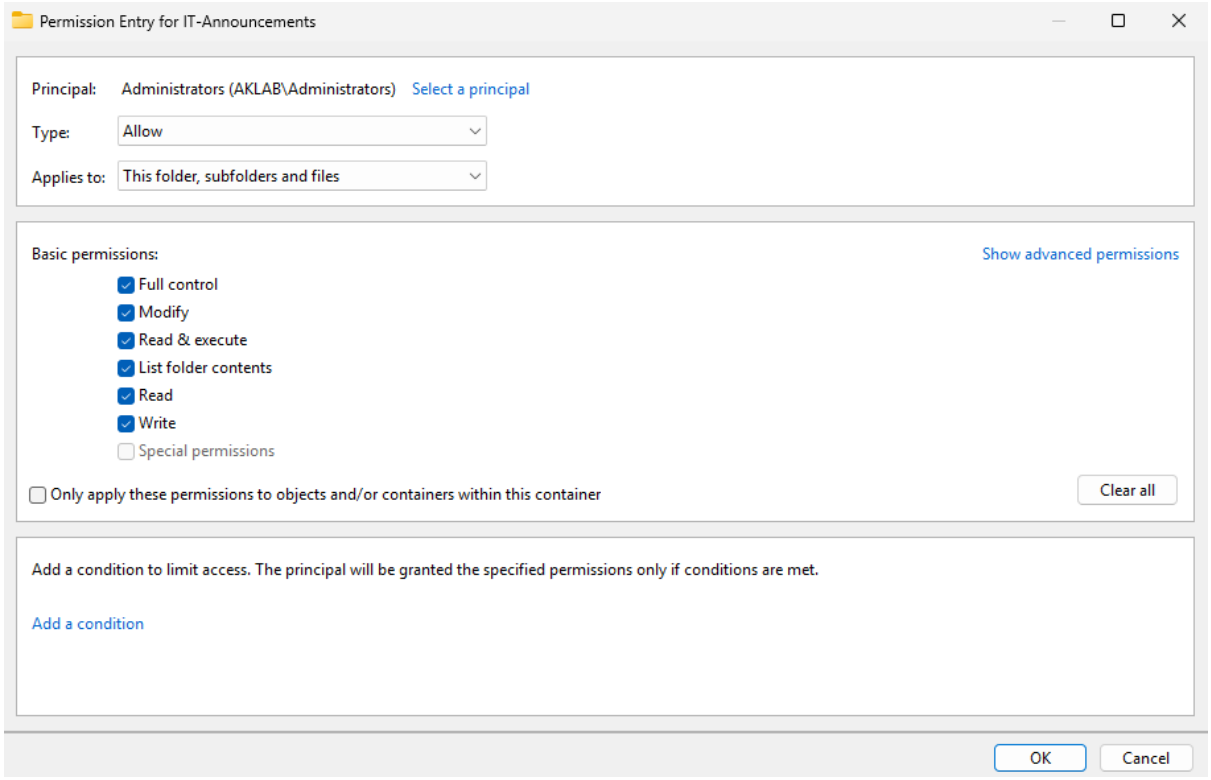


Figure 3: Letting the administrators have almost full access to read, write and execute

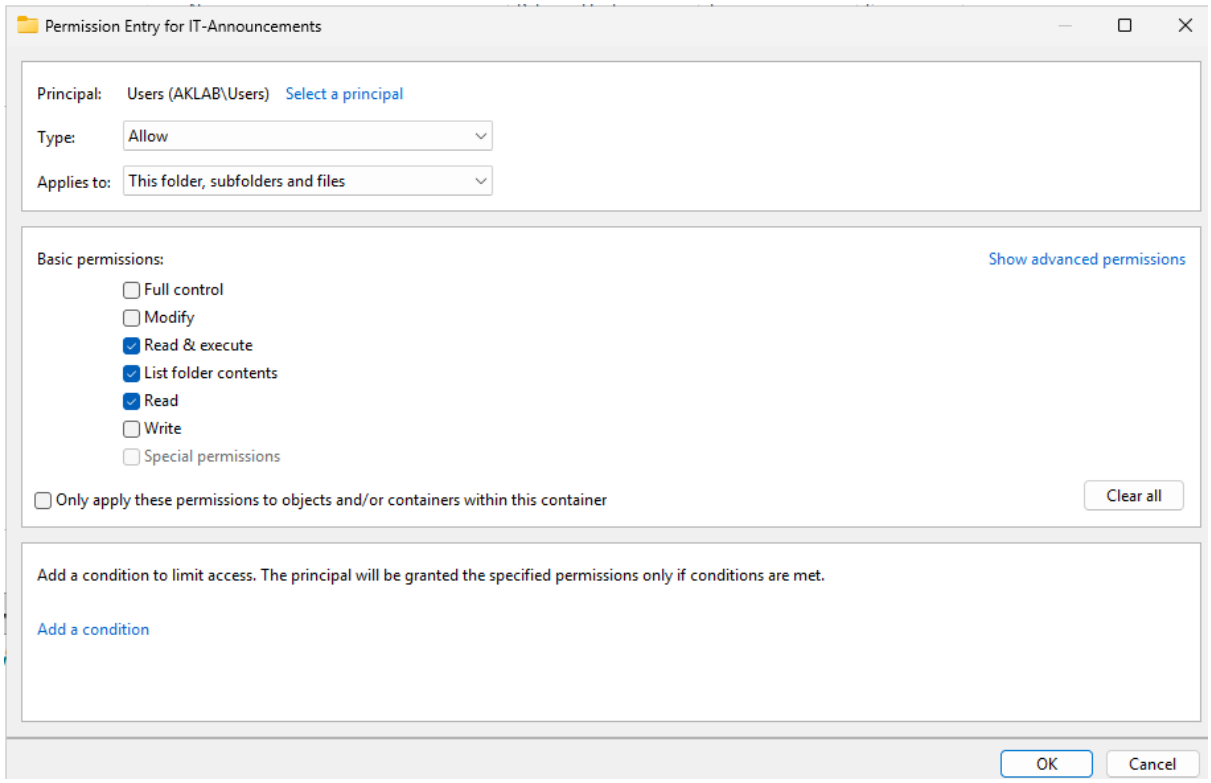


Figure 4: For the users: to read and execute

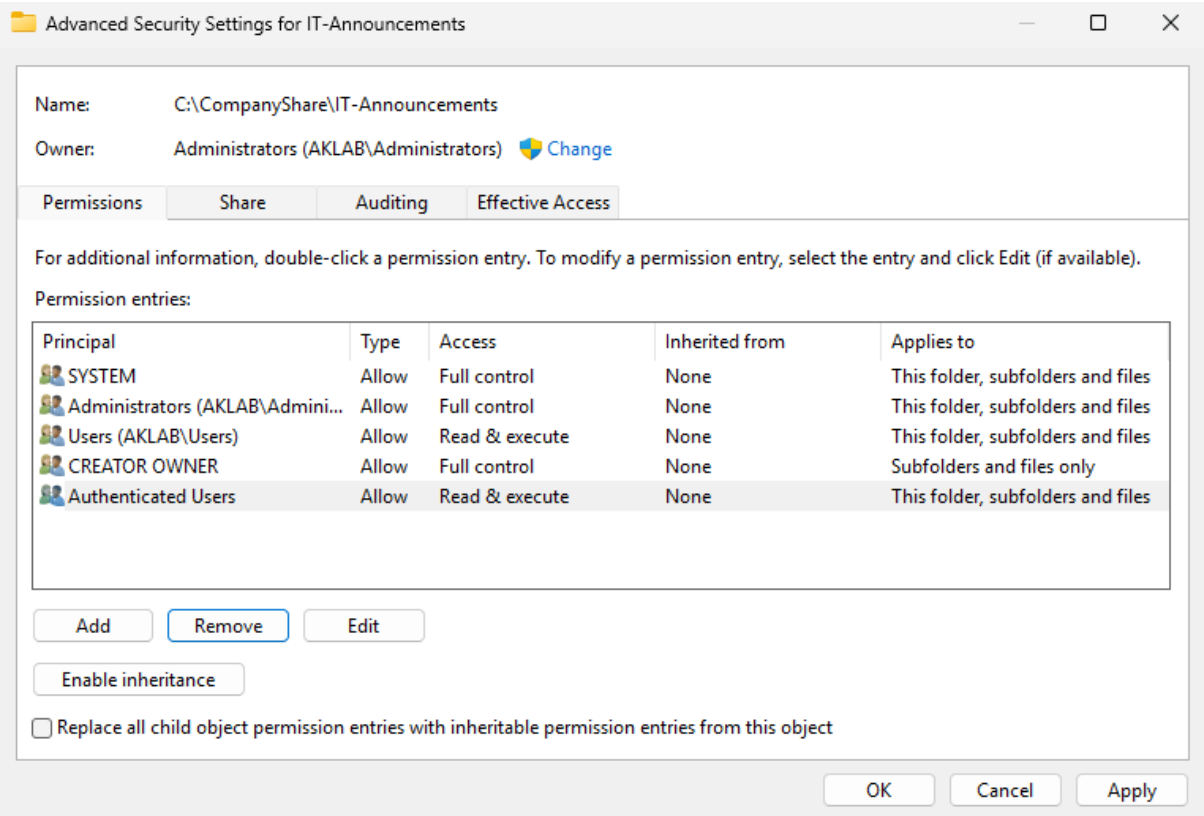


Figure 5: This is how the permissions look now

Let's create a test file for now:

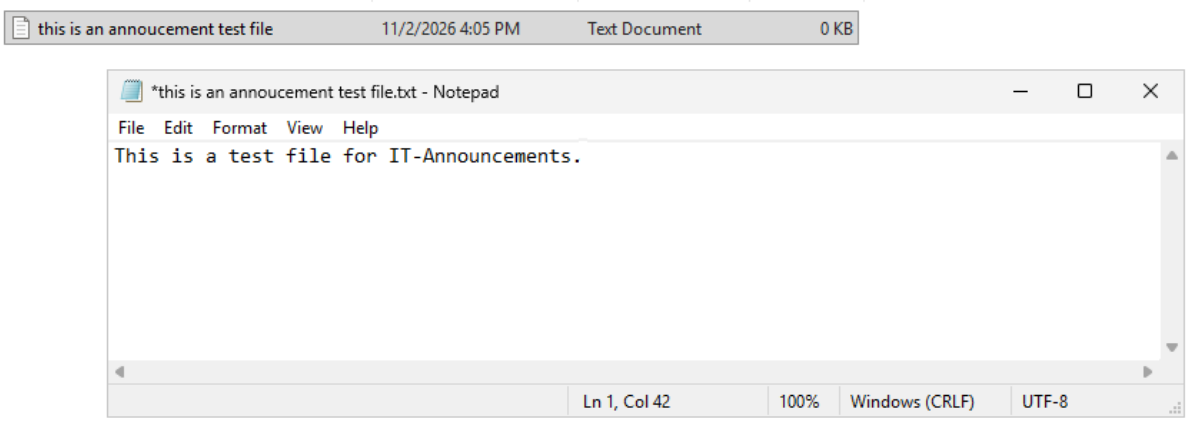


Figure 6: A test file is created

Let’s create the first announcement .json file:

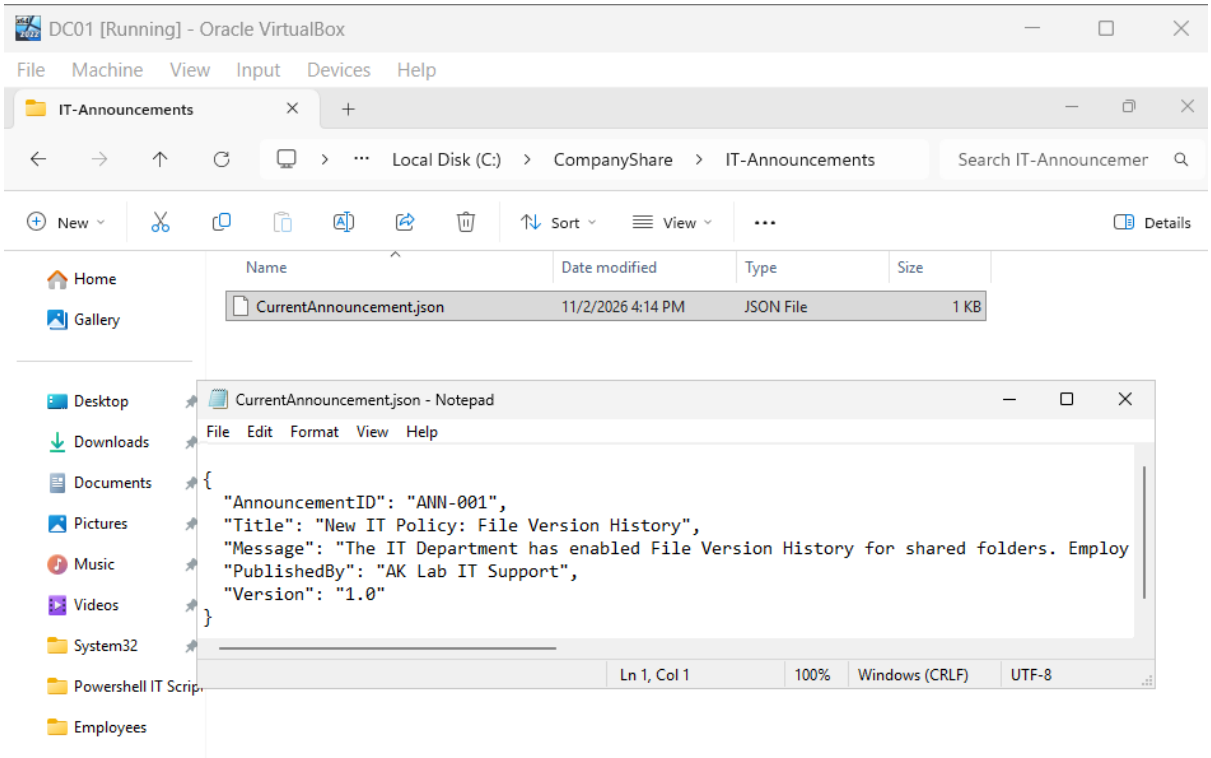


Figure 7: CurrentAnnouncement.json file is created

The previous test file is deleted, and a new CurrentAnnouncement.json file is created.

Let’s create a PowerShell script to automate the process:

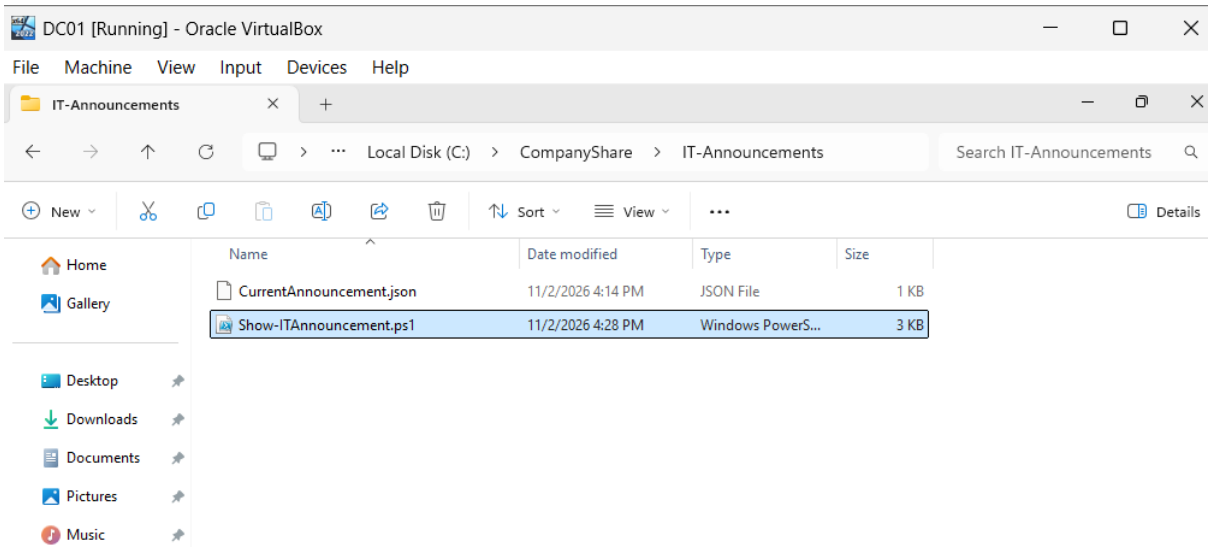


Figure 8: A PowerShell script is created

Script used: [Show-IT-Announcements.ps1]

Let’s create a GPO in Group Policy Management to automate this process:

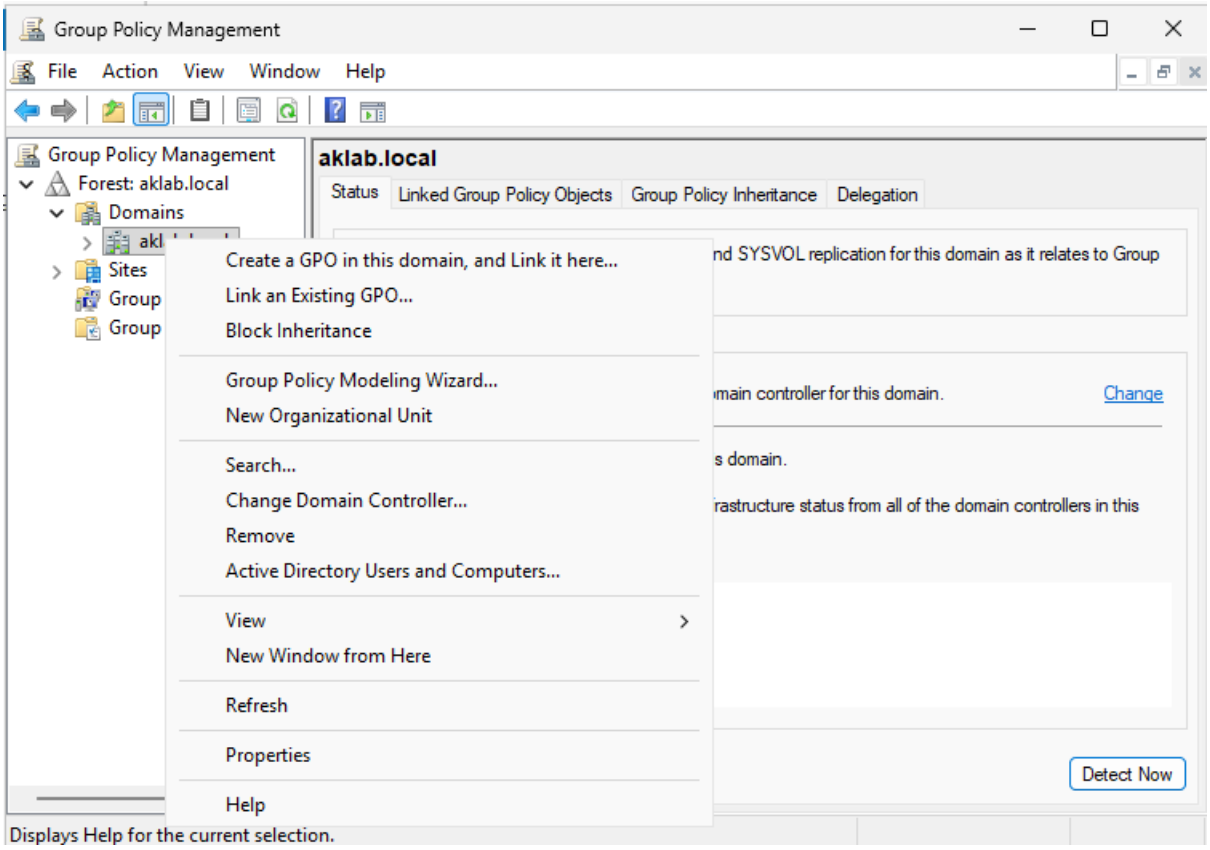


Figure 9: Creating a GPO

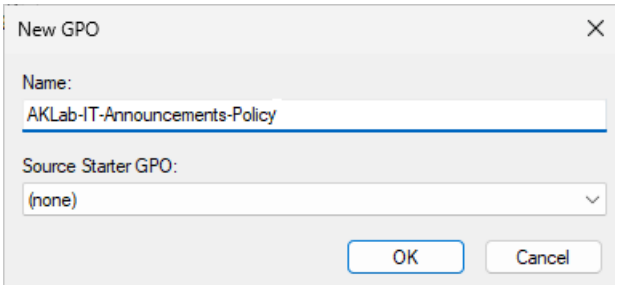


Figure 10: New GPO dialogue box

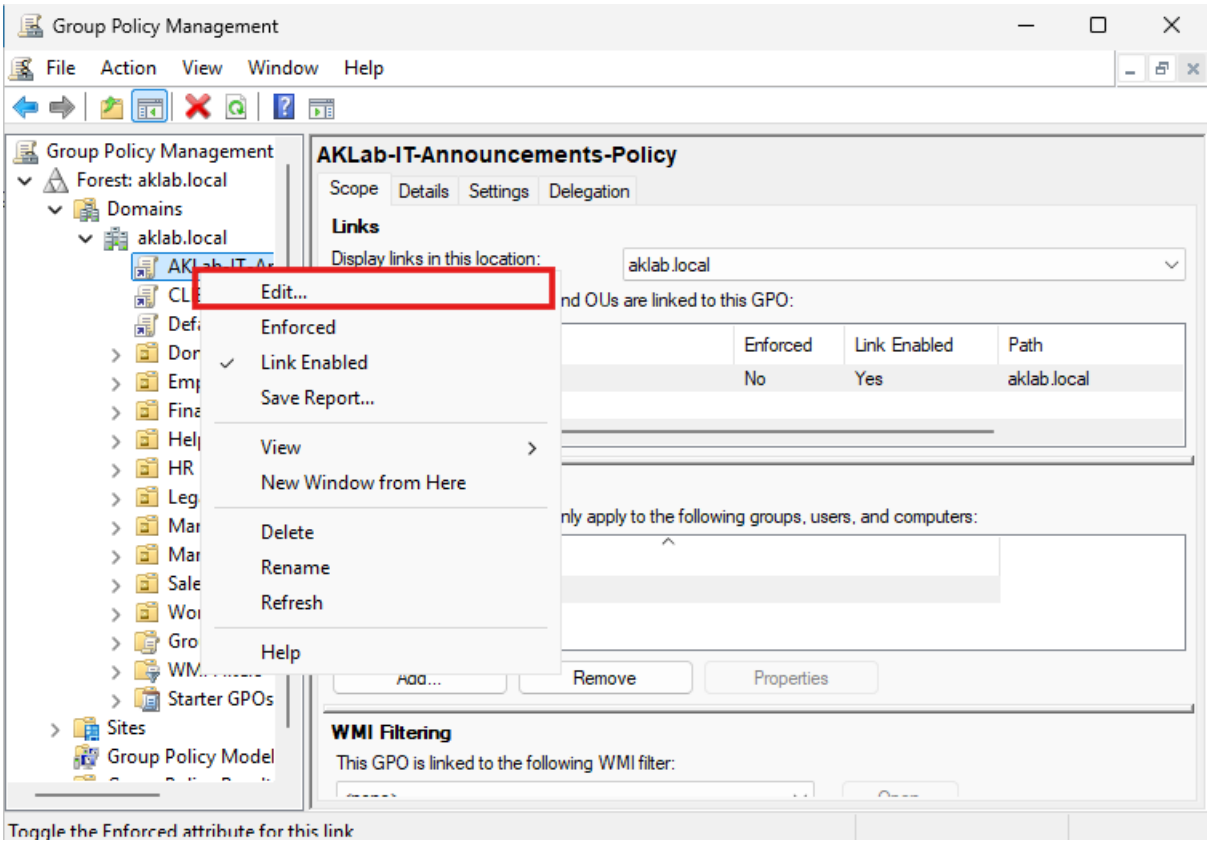


Figure 11: Editing the GPO

Under **User Configuration > Policies > Windows Settings > Scripts (Logon/Logoff):**

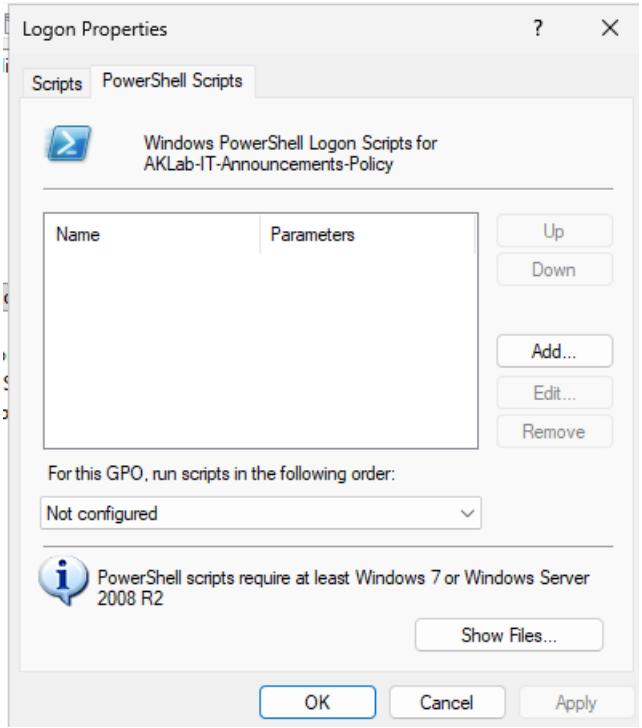


Figure 12: Setting up the logon properties

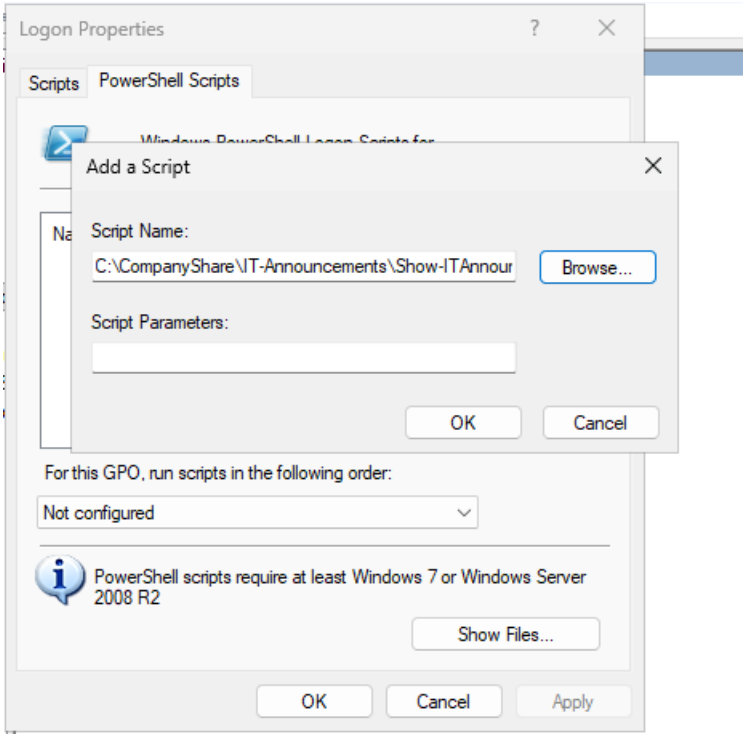


Figure 13: Browsed and added the file

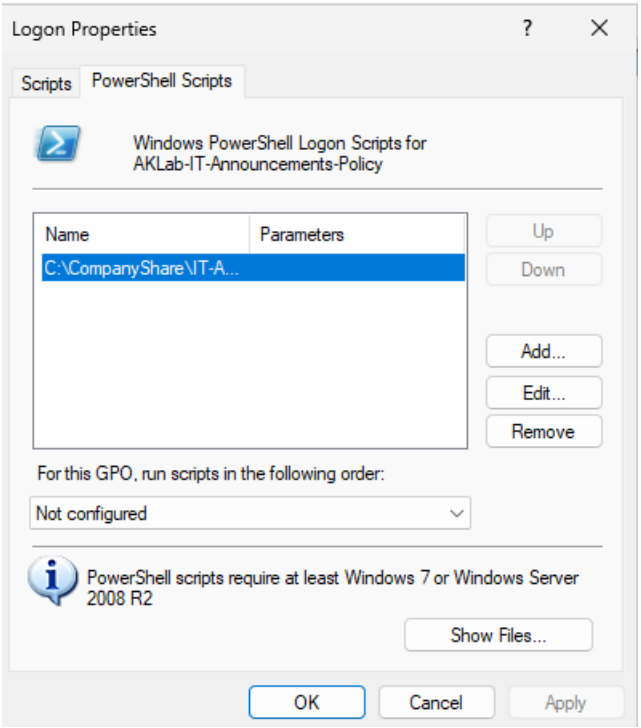


Figure 14: Applied the settings

Checking the policy under:

User **Configuration > Policies > Administrative Templates > System > Scripts > Run logon scripts synchronously**

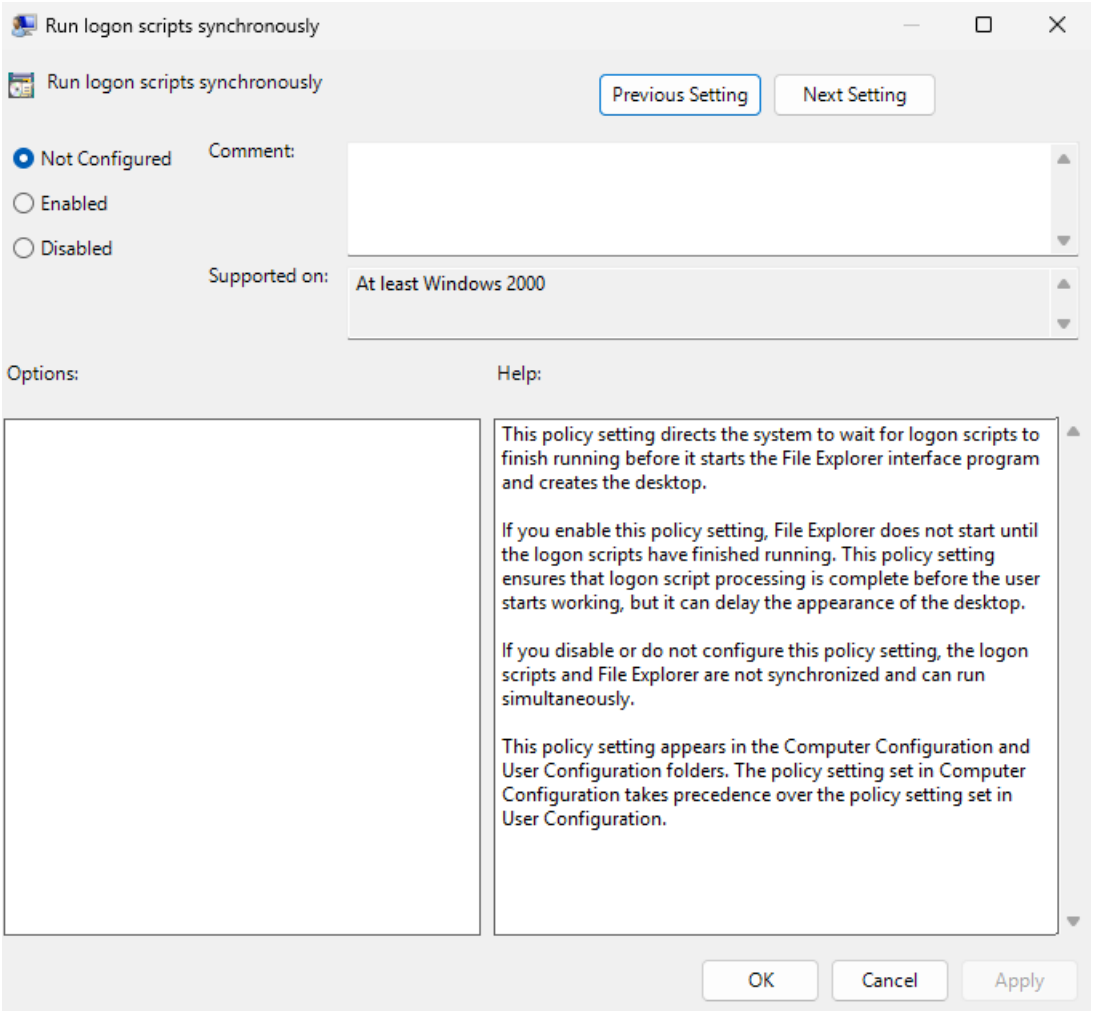


Figure 15: The policy is set to Not Configured and the settings are applied

1.1

We realised that the script needs to be stored inside the GPO, configuring the settings, and checking the existing logon files inside the folder:

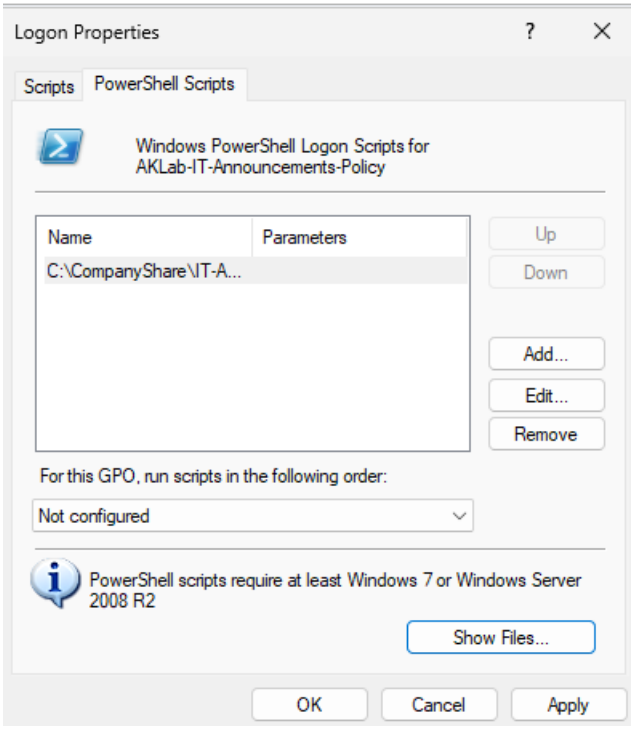


Figure 16: Checking the existing files

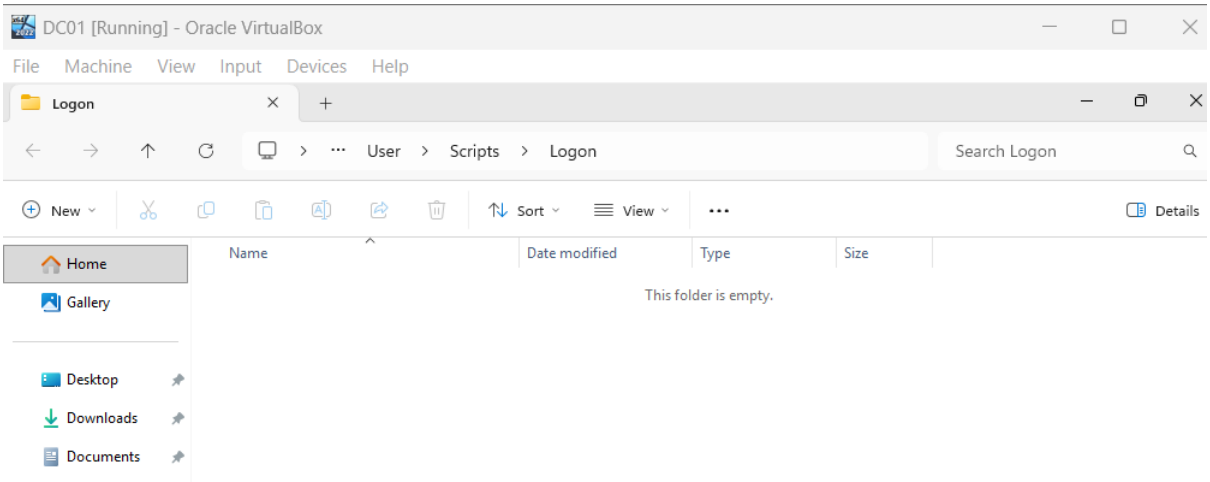


Figure 17: The folder is empty

Adding the PowerShell script file to this folder.

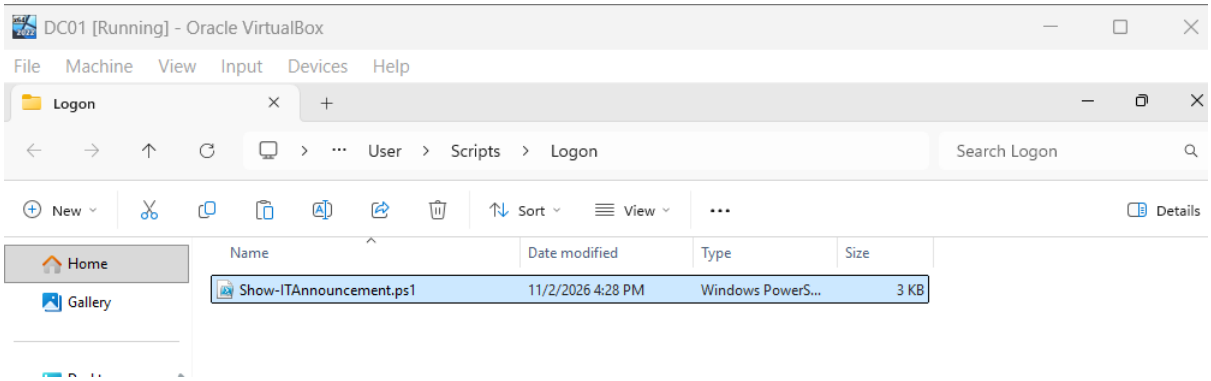


Figure 18: Pasting the file

Let's test on another user.

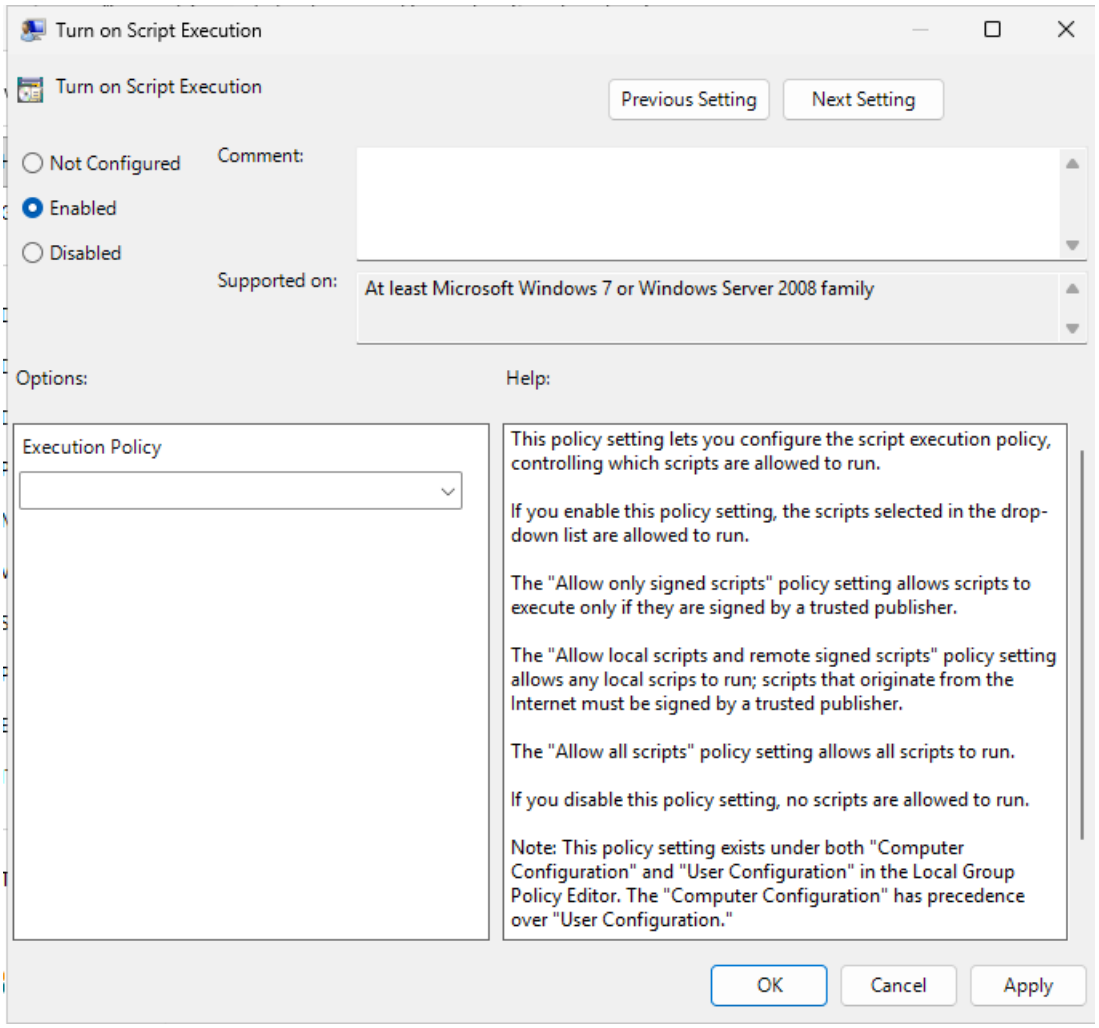


Figure 19: The policy is enabled

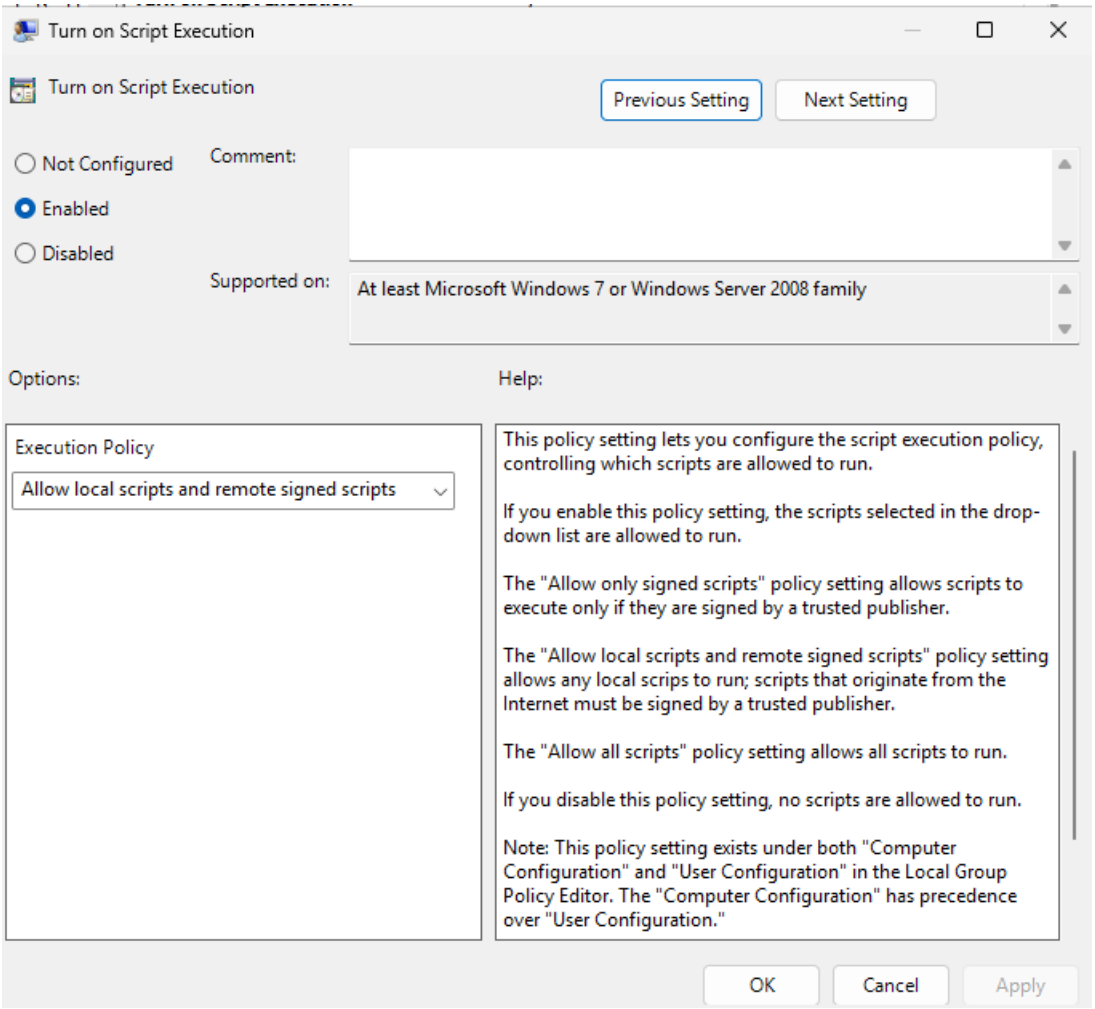


Figure 20: Applying this policy

Because this way is not working, let's try to schedule the task:

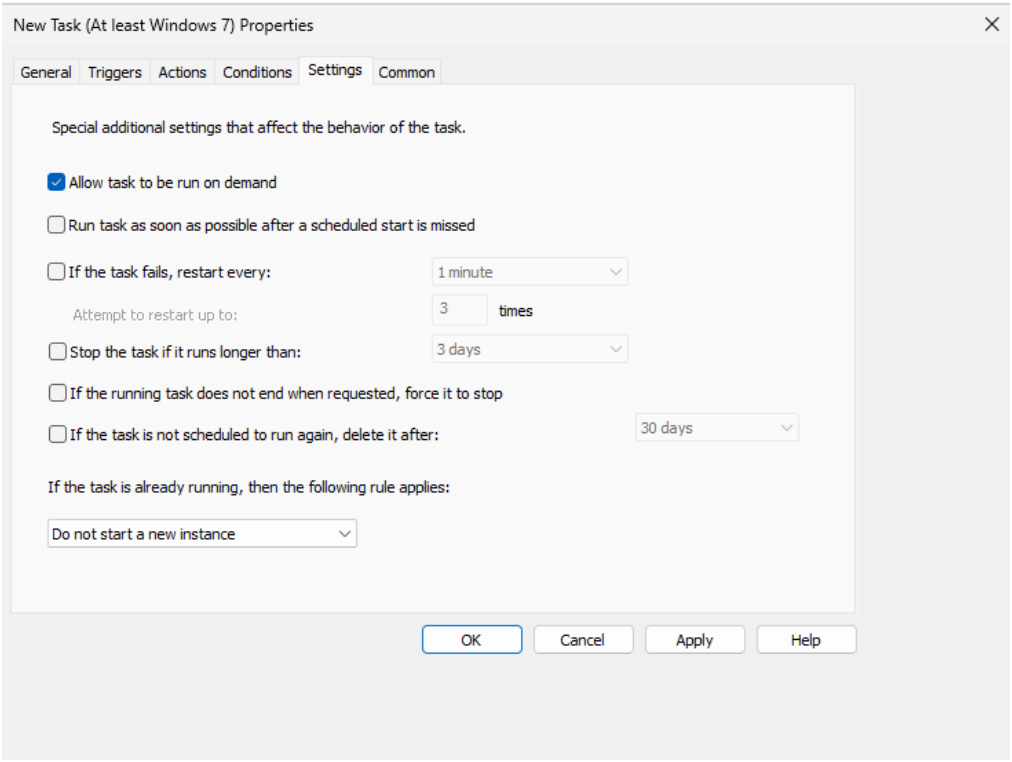


Figure 21: Scheduling the task

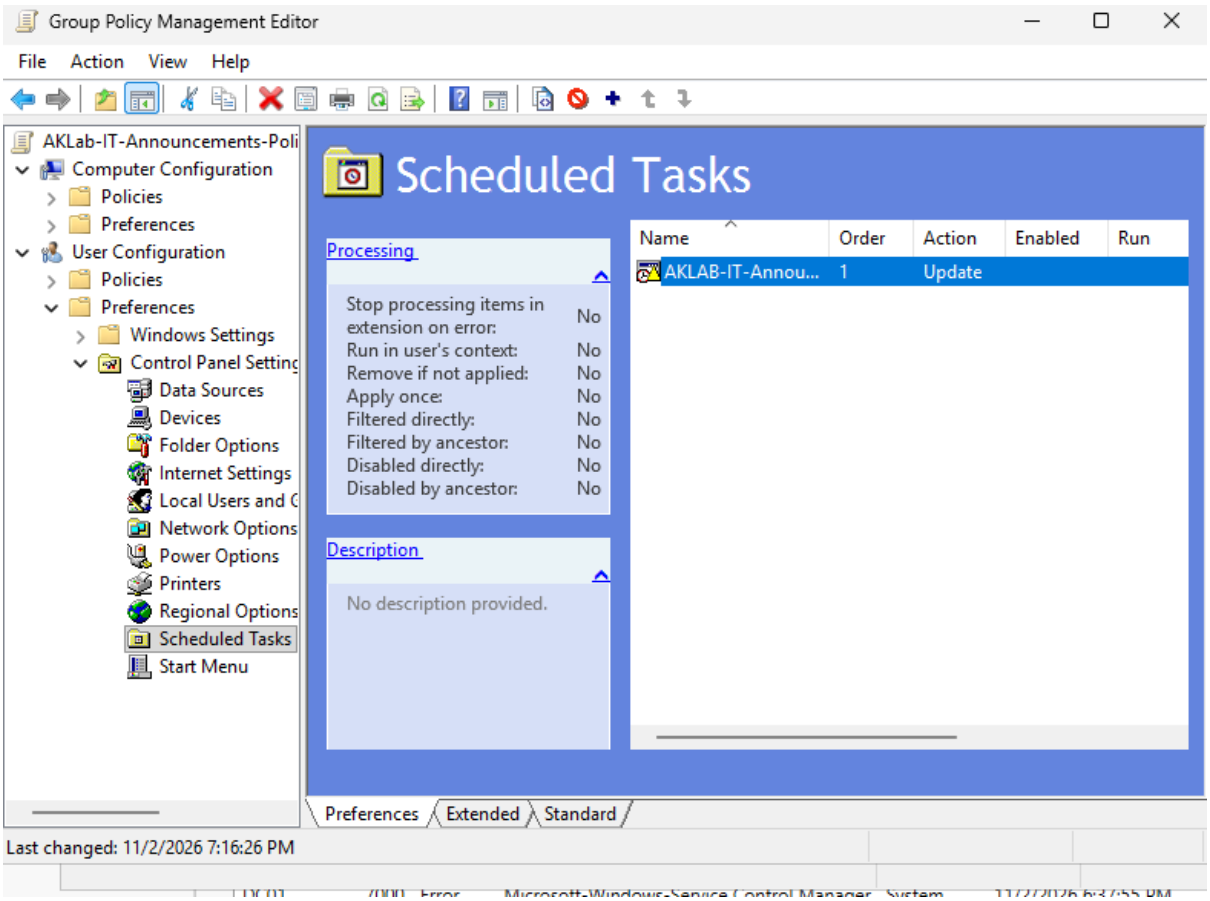


Figure 22: The task has been scheduled

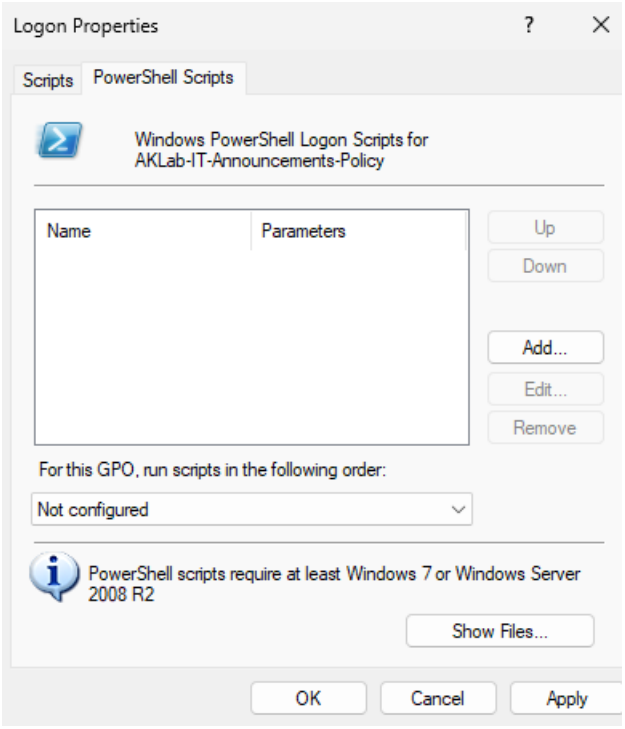


Figure 23: Removing the file to run from logon

Removing the file from Logon Properties to avoid repetition.

Let’s check again on Jamie Taylor's account:

```
Enabled               : True
EndBoundary           :
ExecutionTimeLimit    :
Id                    :
Repetition            : MSFT_TaskRepetitionPattern
StartBoundary         :
Delay                 : PT30S
UserId                :
PSComputerName        :
CimClass              : Root/Microsoft/Windows/TaskScheduler:MSFT_TaskLogonTrigger
CimInstanceProperties : {Enabled, EndBoundary, ExecutionTimeLimit, Id...}
CimSystemProperties   : Microsoft.Management.Infrastructure.CimSystemProperties
```

Activate Windows

Figure 24: After execution result

The task didn’t start automatically; let's manually configure it:

By running this command:

```
Start-ScheduledTask -TaskName "AKLab-IT-Announcement"
```

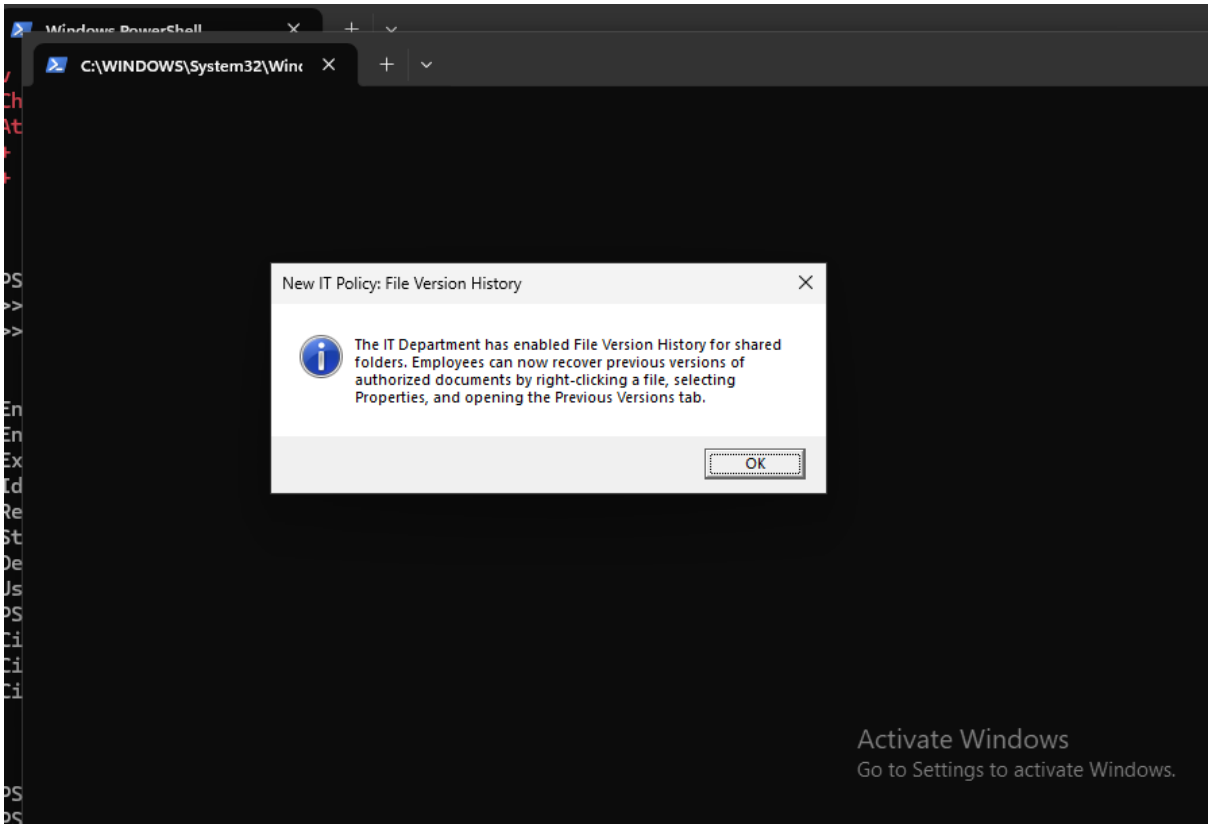


Figure 25: Result after running the command

After rechecking all the settings and restarting the account, we can see the message pop-up appears itself after 30 seconds, as intended on Jamie Taylor's account:

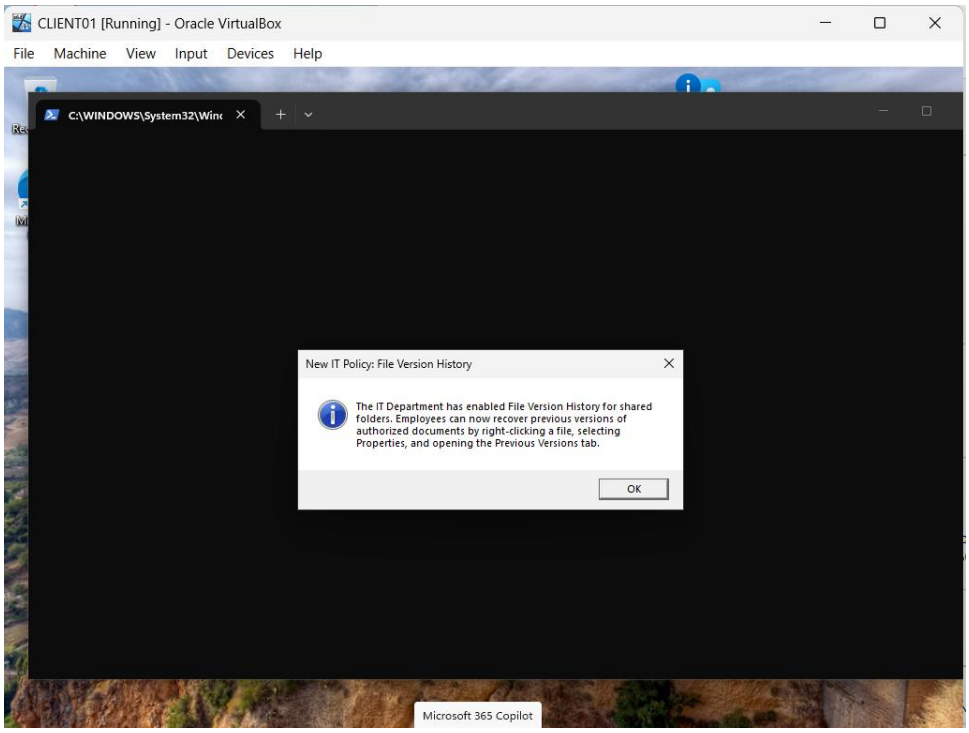


Figure 26: The pop-up message appears successfully

6. Validation

Let's check if an employee, let's say Jamie Taylor, can read the folder but cannot write or make other changes to it:

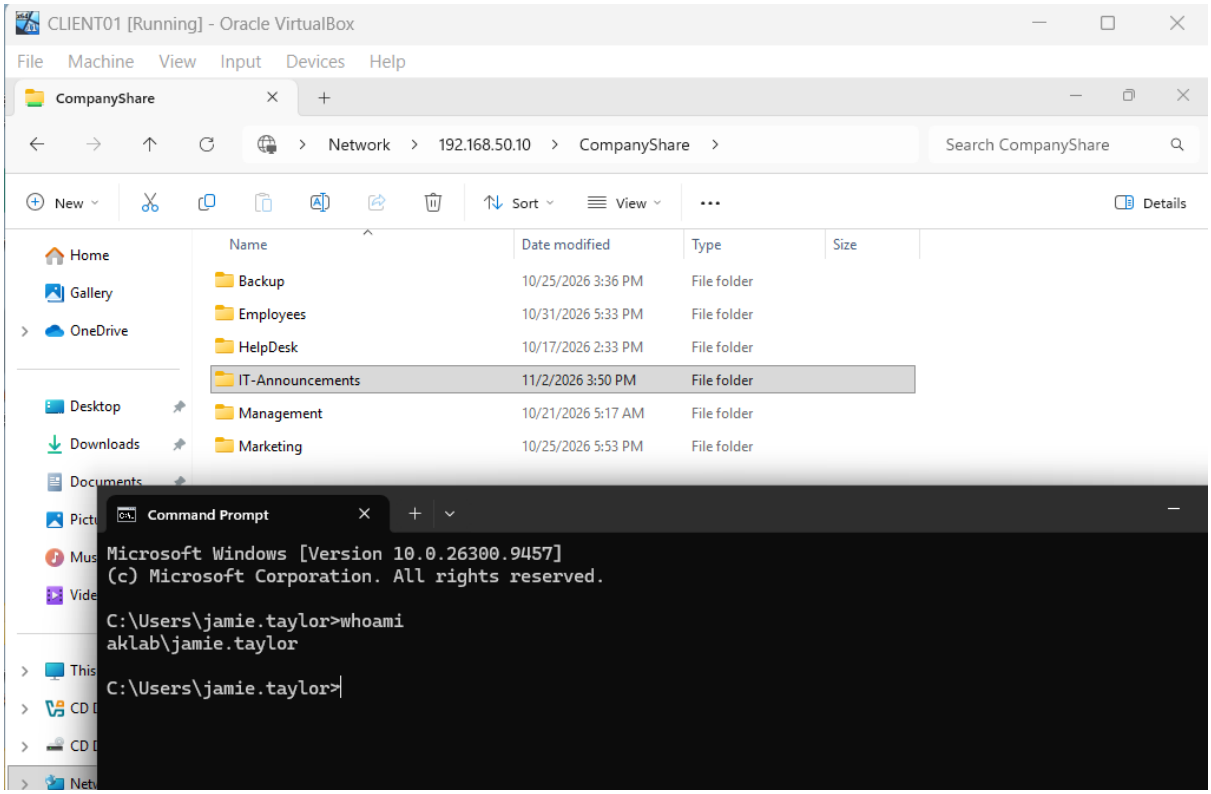


Figure 27: Jamie can access the folder

When Jamie Taylor tries to delete the file:

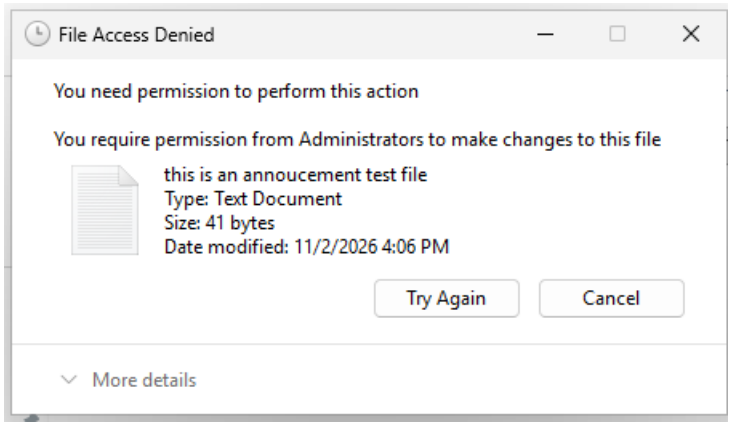


Figure 28: Needs permission to delete the file

So, the permissions are working fine.

Let's check if Jamie Taylor can read the new announcement by testing manually:

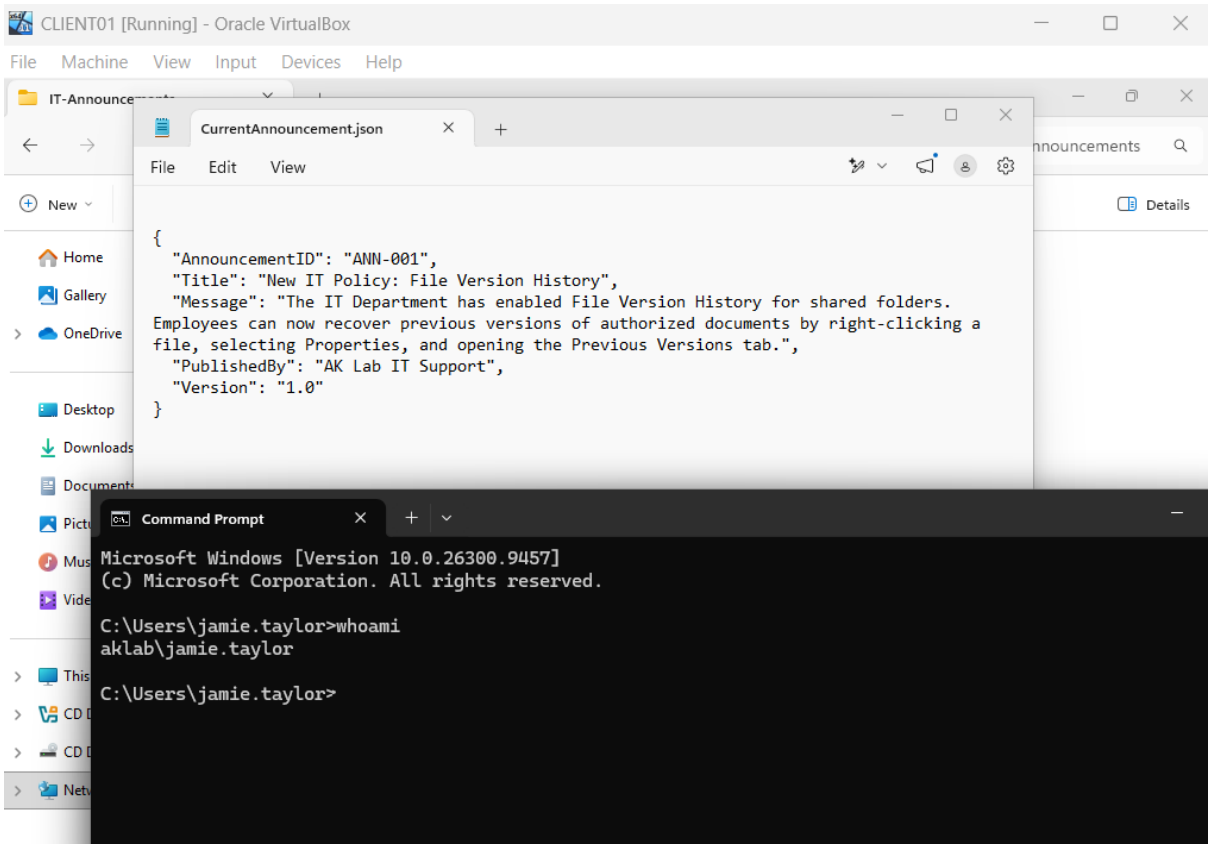


Figure 29: Jamie can successfully read the file

Let's test the script manually on Jamie Taylor's account:

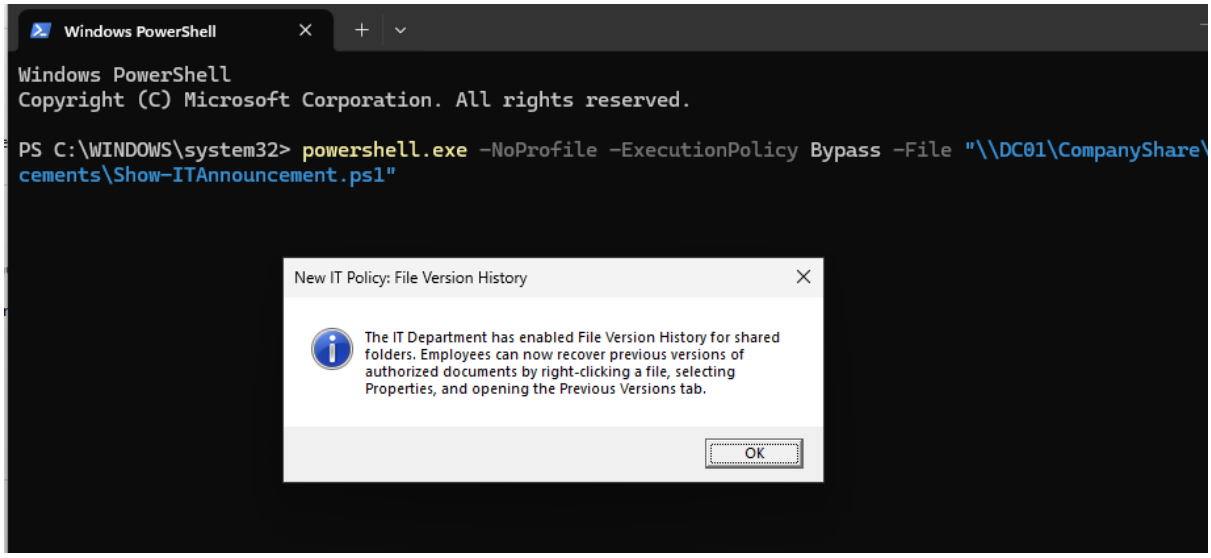


Figure 30: The message displays successfully

Now that the automation script is made, let's check if it appears automatically when Jamie Taylor signs in to her account:

Because Jamie Taylor has already seen the announcement before, let's test it with another account.

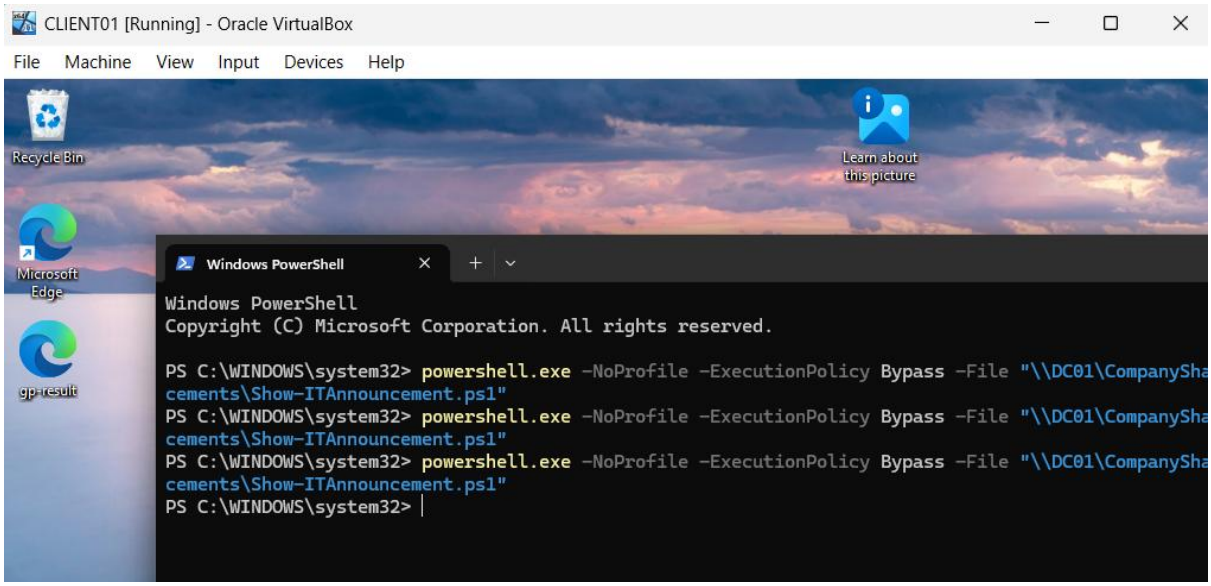


Figure 31: Trying manual run of the announcement

The script is running when trying to run manually, but it is not running automatically

Let's try to configure the settings, [1.1]

After configuring the settings:

Result:

Test Case 1: Jamie Taylor

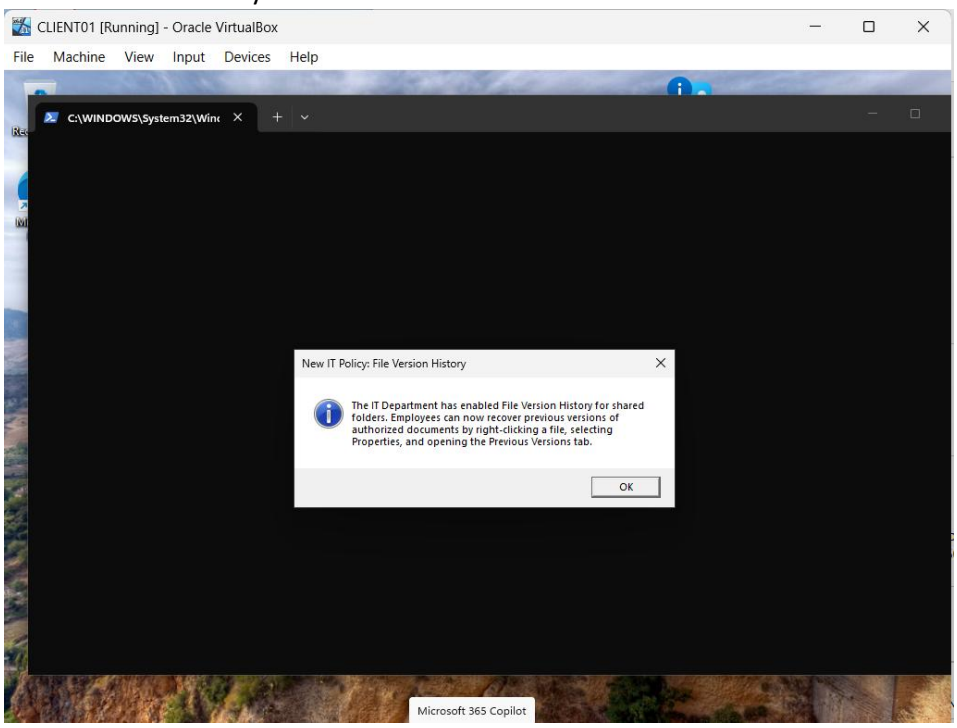


Figure 32: Jamie Taylor can successfully read the announcement

Test Case 2: Alex Morgan

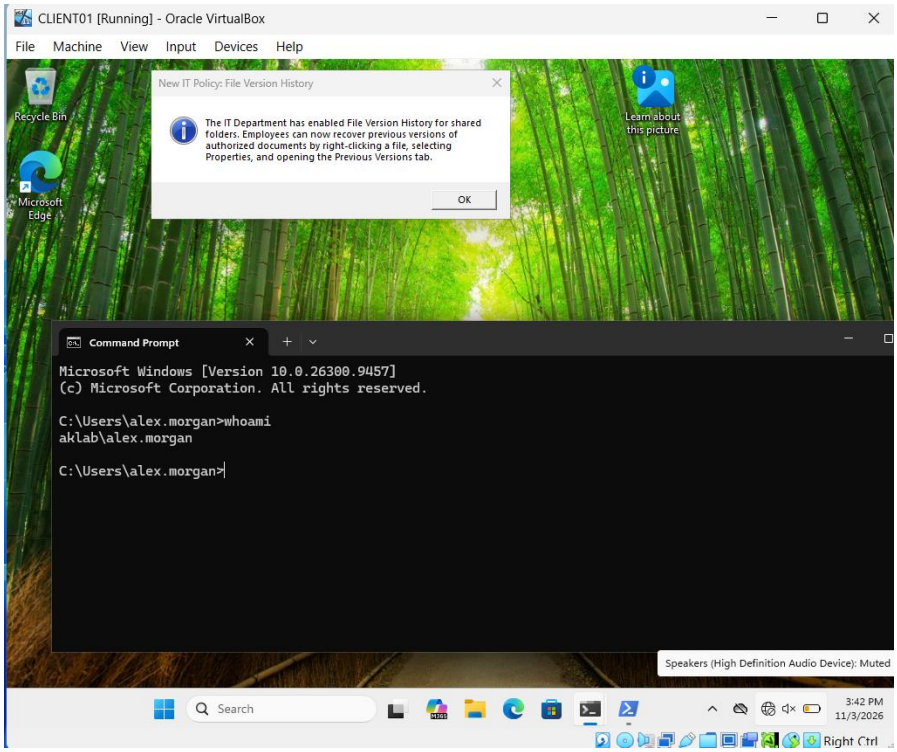


Figure 33: Alex Morgan can successfully read the announcement

Test Case 3: Olivia Martin

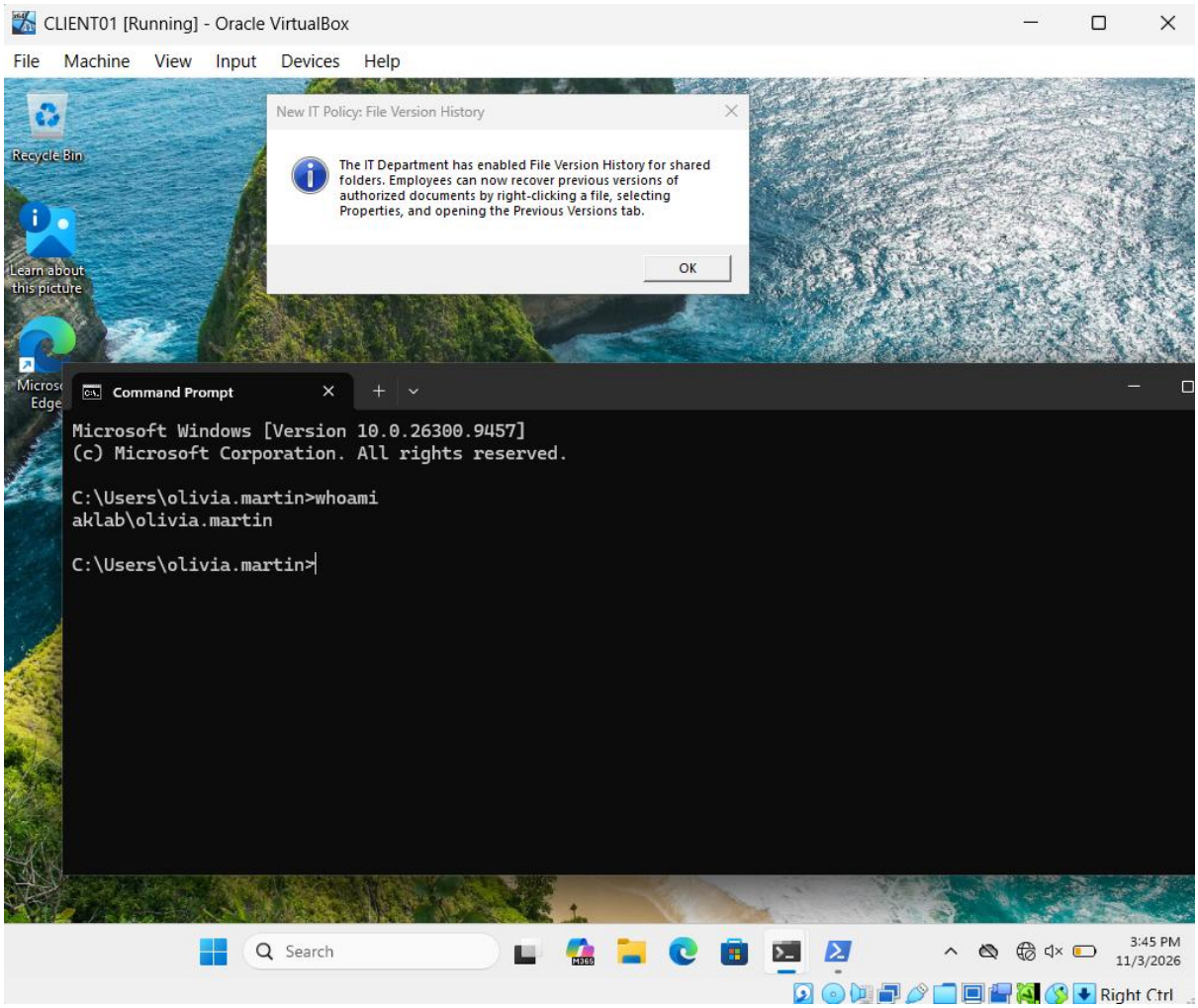


Figure 34: Olivia Martin can successfully read the announcement

Ticket Resolved!